ABOUT THIS PIECE

Lesson plan: phonological awareness

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WHAT IT IS

A 35-minute 5th-grade lesson on decoding multisyllabic words through syllables, morphemes, and phonemes, using gradual release (I do, we do, you do).

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How the lesson moves from teacher modeling to independent practice.

5TH GRADE · STUDENT TEACHING · EDU 325

Phonological Awareness

Multisyllabic Word Decoding Through Syllables, Morphemes & Phonemes

STANDARD	TIME	MODEL
Alabama Course of Study — decode multisyllabic words using syllables, morphemes & phonemes	35 minutes	Gradual Release (I Do / We Do / You Do)

Objective

Students will use their knowledge of syllables, prefixes, suffixes, and root words to segment, blend, and manipulate sounds in multisyllabic words, demonstrating their ability to analyze word structure and meaning.

Materials

- Word cards with multisyllabic words, including prefixes, suffixes, and roots (e.g., “unbelievable,” “reconstruction”)
- Morpheme charts (prefix / root / suffix breakdown)
- Sentence strips for contextual word practice
- Dry-erase boards and markers
- A timer for group activities

Lesson Plan

Introduction (5 min)
Activate prior knowledge: “When you come across a really long word in a book, how do you figure it out?” Connect to the day's learning: “Today, we'll break big words into smaller parts using their sounds and meanings.”

I Do — Teacher-Led (10 min)
Display the word *unbelievable*. Break it into morphemes: prefix *un-* (“not”), root *believe* (“to think or trust”), suffix *-able* (“able to”). Segment into syllables (un-be-liev-a-ble) and phonemes, then blend the parts back together and explain the meaning: “not able to believe.”

We Do — Guided Practice (15 min)
As a class, break down *reconstruction* and *misunderstanding* into morphemes and phonemes using sentence strips, e.g. “The reconstruction of the old house took years.” Ask: “What does ‘reconstruction’ mean here? How does the prefix ‘re-’ change the meaning?”

You Do — Independent Practice (15 min)
In small groups, students receive 5 multisyllabic words (from: disapproval, unreliable, miscommunication, preexisting, inconceivable). Task 1: break each into syllables, morphemes, and phonemes. Task 2: write each word in a sentence that shows its meaning.

Closing (5 min)

Class discussion: “What strategies did you use today to figure out unfamiliar words?” Connect to real-world relevance in reading, science, and math.

Morpheme Reference Chart

Word	Prefix	Root	Suffix	Meaning
Unbelievable	un- (not)	believe	-able (able to)	Not able to believe
Reconstruction	re- (again)	construct	-ion (act of)	Act of building again
Misunderstanding	mis- (wrong)	understand	-ing (action)	Understanding wrongly
Disapproval	dis- (not)	approve	-al (related to)	Not agreeing
Preexisting	pre- (before)	exist	-ing (action)	Existing before
Inconceivable	in- (not)	conceive	-able (able to)	Not able to imagine

Adapted Version (No Word Cards or Whiteboards)

Built after reflecting on pacing in the original lesson: words are displayed digitally or written on the board rather than on physical cards, and independent practice moves to a printed worksheet with columns for prefix / root / suffix, syllables and phonemes, and a sentence showing the word's meaning. Everything else follows the same Gradual Release structure.

Reflection

Students engaged well with the hands-on segmentation and responded strongly to the I Do / We Do / You Do structure. The main growth area identified afterward was pacing — independent practice benefited from a few extra minutes, which is what prompted the adapted, low-materials version above.